

CSCI [334](#)
Section: 54
Course ID: 001226
Communication for Computing Sciences
Fall 2026 SYLLABUS

INSTRUCTOR: Andrew A. Anda, Ph.D., Professor of Computer Science
OFFICE: Room 366AE, Centennial Hall Telephone: (320) 308-2044
E-MAIL: aanda@stcloudstate.edu (prefix all "**Subject:**" text with
"**CSCI334:**" for emails relating to this class)

INSTRUCTOR'S WEEKLY SCHEDULE:
<https://aanda-stcloudstate.edu.github.io/WebSpace/Wkly-sched-f26.pdf> (and by
appointment)

Student Support Hours: <https://minnstate.zoom.us/j/7680194778>

{I sometimes won't be available for a Student Support hour - this will
usually be because I'm attending a meeting}

Content Delivery and Accessibility:

The delivery method is "**Completely Online - asynchronous**".

CLASS TIME AND LOCATION:

{Lectures are posted to D2L}

Sec 54: Asynchronous online

REQUIRED TEXTS: * Writing For Computer Science 3rd Ed. [paperback], Justin
Zobel, Springer, 2015; ISBN-13: 978-1-4471-6638-2.
(check our D2L page for a PDF copy)

COURSE DESCRIPTION:

Oral and written communication in the context of the computing sciences.
Intended to be taken in the *penultimate* semester of the program.

SLOs:

* Acquire those oral and written communication skills required for
effective performance as computer scientists.

PREREQUISITES:

CSCI331 - Software Systems

INTENT:

The intent of this class is to evaluate a compilation/portfolio of your
writing demonstrating the breadth

and quality of the several contexts of computer science writing expected
of a Computer Science major program undergraduate student.

Each assignment exhibits a different modality of computer science
writing, a research paper and its presentation,

and the following writing artifacts expected as deliverable components of
a software development project:

- * literate programming (usually via Doxygen),
- * source code documentation,
- * user manual documentation,

- * design documentation
- * testing documentation

ASSIGNMENTS:

Assignments are due in their D2L dropbox by their due-date and time.

Late work may be accepted as long as the D2L assignment drop box remains open.

All assignments can represent prior work you have written for other CSCI courses,

as long as that work is exclusively your own work -- documents you *collaborated* on are **not** acceptable.

(e.g. your CSCI 331 Doxygen assignment PDF can be submitted)

If you haven't produced (*by yourself*) an example of an assignment in another class, you are expected to generate an example for this class.

The five software development documents **do not** have to be from the same project -- they can *all* be from different projects.

However, the research paper presentation (slides) **must** describe the research paper you submit.

Your writing must not be AI generated.

ACADEMIC HONESTY:

You are expected to do your own work. If you copy someone else's work or allow someone else to copy your work, you are being academically dishonest and will be subject to severe disciplinary action which may include any or all of: no credit for the work in question, a failing grade

for the course, notification to the university that you have violated your

Code of Conduct.

GRADING:

Your grade will be determined by the contributions of your scores on Assignments.

APPROXIMATE POINTS:

Assignments 100%

NO FINAL EXAM

Resource Links:

- [D2L Brightspace](#)
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- [SCSU Student Resources for Online Learning](#)
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- [SCSU Zoom Resources](#)
-
- [SCSU Student Information for Attending Classes Off-Campus](#)
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- [SCSU: The Write Place](#)
-
- [SCSU Information Technology Services](#)
-
- [SCSU Medical Clinic](#)
-
- [SCSU Counseling and Psychological Services](#)
-
- [SCSU Library](#)
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- [SCSU Student Code of Conduct](#)

Student accessibility Services

Student Accessibility Services maintains Accessibility Syllabus Statements for faculty to include in their course syllabi. Check out the Student Accessibility Services [Faculty and Staff Resources webpage](#) for additional information statements, the accommodation process, and more. The below syllabus statement sample is supported by Student Accessibility Services:

Accessibility Statement:

This course is designed with accessibility in mind and aims to be inclusive to all students. If you encounter barriers to accessing course materials, participating fully, or demonstrating your learning, please don't hesitate to reach out. I am committed to working with you to ensure equitable access. Students who have a disability, or who think they may benefit from formal accommodations, are encouraged to contact Student Accessibility Services (SAS) as early as possible. SAS is located at Centennial Hall 210 and can be reached at 320-308-4080 or sas@stcloudstate.edu. For more information or to request accommodations, please visit www.stcloudstate.edu/sas.

EAB Navigate Student Success Tool

- St. Cloud State University uses the Navigate platform, which allows faculty and advisors to provide proactive and coordinated care for students. Throughout the semester, I may submit updates on students with attendance or academic concerns so that advisors can reach out to provide additional support and/or connect you to campus resources. I may also contact you through email, before or after class, or encourage you to meet with me during my office hours. Please know I'm here to support you in your academic success. You can learn more about the Navigate tool at [Navigate | St. Cloud State University](#)

Student Support Hours (Office Hours):

- **Student Support Hours are dedicated times when I am available to support you and your success.** During these hours, I am fully available to meet with you, whether to discuss course content, assignments, academic planning, or other questions you may have. I may be working on other tasks, but if you arrive, that time becomes student focused.

- Student Support Hours may be held in person or virtually, depending on the course format. If you are unable to meet during the scheduled times, I am happy to arrange an alternative meeting when possible. You are also welcome to stop by at other times if my door is open; if I am unavailable at that moment, we can schedule a time to connect.
- Think of these hours as an open invitation to engage - no appointment, no pressure, and no staring sadly out the window required.

Syllabus statement for faculty who are supportive of exploratory use of AI

- Artificial Intelligence (AI) is a tool available to the public. Within this course, you are expected to submit assignments and discussions that are your original thought. Within this course, you are encouraged to explore how AI may impact routine tasks within our profession. The use of AI for brainstorming, outlining, or creating support for your academic assignments is allowable in this course. Submitting AI-generated assignments as your own original thought is considered to breach our Academic Integrity practices and should not occur. Please ask me if you are unsure of where AI and Academic Integrity intersect in this course. Please refer to the Academic Integrity policies that apply to all courses within our institution.
- Supported tools such as Copilot and Adobe AI tools may be used in this course for limited academic tasks such as idea generation, outlining, or early-stage revisions. However, all submitted work must reflect your own understanding, voice, and academic reasoning.

AI tools should serve as a support, not a replacement, for your thinking. Submitting work that is primarily AI-generated without acknowledgment is a breach of our Academic Integrity Policy.

If you use AI tools as part of your process, you must be transparent about how they were used (e.g., “Used Copilot to draft bullet points; expanded and revised with personal analysis”). When in doubt, ask for clarification before submitting your work.

Please consult the Academic Integrity Policy for more information and let’s maintain an open dialogue about ethical and responsible technology use.

Our Land Commitment

St. Cloud State University is committed to developing a land acknowledgment that is not just words but actions. We will actively promote education among our faculty, staff, and students on Indigenous issues, including research on the historical and ongoing harms impacting our Indigenous communities. We will also clearly outline our goals to make a positive and lasting contribution to efforts to build relationships with the Tribal Nations represented within our local and broader community. St. Cloud State University commits to creating a substantive and empathic land acknowledgment, demonstrating our continued commitment to action. Faculty are encouraged to learn more about **Our Land Commitment** on the [OEA Land Commitment webpage](#) for the most up to date information.

Additional SCSU student resources, curated and compiled by the Academic Affairs office, are presented in:
[Fall 2023 Student Instructional Resource and Support Guide](#)

CAVEAT:

I reserve the right to amend the contents of this syllabus with
notification.

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